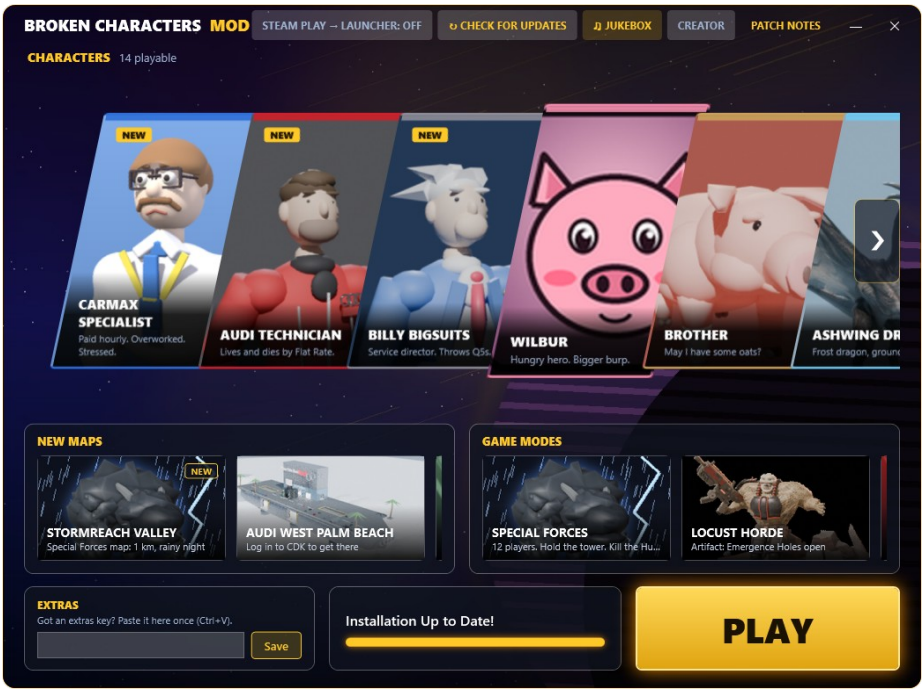
BROKEN CHARACTERS MOD

Install, Update & Creator Guide



Part 1: Playing the pack

First time? Start here — it takes about 5 minutes and you only do it once. You need Risk of Rain 2 on Steam, on a Windows PC, and an internet connection. You do **not** need a mod manager.

1 **Download the launcher.**
Open the latest release and click **Broken-Characters-Mod.exe**. Move it to your Desktop (not left in Downloads) so it has a stable home.

2 **Let Windows allow it.**
If a blue box says "Windows protected your PC": click **More info**, then **Run anyway**. This happens because the app is new, not because anything is wrong.

3 **Let it install.**
The launcher finds Risk of Rain 2 on its own. If it can't, a folder picker appears — pick your Risk of Rain 2 folder (the one with Risk of Rain 2.exe in it). Watch the gold bar; the first install takes a few minutes.

4 **Got a friends-only extras key?**
See **The extras** on the next page. Skip it if you weren't given a key.

5 **Press PLAY.**
It updates anything that needs it, then starts Risk of Rain 2. **Everyone in a lobby needs the same version.**

Updating

You never have to download anything again after the first install — even someone on an older launcher gets quietly swapped onto the newest one the next time it updates. Every time you want to play:

1. **Open the launcher.**
   Use the Desktop shortcut, or just press **Play** in Steam if you turned on **STEAM PLAY → LAUNCHER** (see below).

2. **Press PLAY.**
   In order, it: checks for a newer launcher and swaps itself in if there is one (it restarts on its own, this takes a few seconds); checks for a newer mod pack and installs it; then starts the game. One button, nothing to pick.

3. **Or press CHECK FOR UPDATES any time.**
   The ↻ **CHECK FOR UPDATES** button at the top reloads the character and map cards, the patch notes, and runs the same update check — without starting the game.

Steam Play → Launcher (optional): turn on the **STEAM PLAY → LAUNCHER** toggle at the top once, and from then on Steam's own **Play** button opens this launcher first — updates, then the game.

Patch notes: click **PATCH NOTES** at the top to see what changed in recent updates.

Jukebox: click ♫ **JUKEBOX** to pick the group's songs, download new ones, and vote in-game (press 7/8/9 to vote once the host starts a round).

Test Level (singleplayer only): click ▶️ **TEST LEVEL** to launch straight into a dev-tools test run. It only turns on in singleplayer.

This guide, any time: click the small ❯ arrow tab on the right edge of the launcher window.

Troubleshooting

Can't reach GitHub / no internet: if the pack is already installed, PLAY still works offline — you just won't get the newest update until you're back online.

"Update failed": press **Retry**. If it keeps failing, send a screenshot of the launcher to the group chat.

Windows still won't open it: right-click **Broken-Characters-Mod.exe → Properties →** tick **Unblock** (bottom right) **→ OK**, then try again.

The launcher looks stuck / didn't relaunch after an update: close it and open it again from the Desktop shortcut or Steam. If it still won't start, download it fresh from the latest release.

Multiplayer: everyone in the lobby needs the same build, so press PLAY (or CHECK FOR UPDATES) before you invite people.

The extras (optional)

Some sounds and art in the pack can’t be shared publicly, so they come as a separate "extras" download that needs a key.

> **Ask the pack owner for your extras key — it’s not printed in this copy of the guide.**

1. **Get your extras key from the owner.**
   They’ll send it to you directly — never post it in a public channel.
2. **In the launcher, find the EXTRAS box in the bottom left.**
3. **Paste the key into the box (click it, press Ctrl+V) and click Save.**
4. **The launcher reinstalls once and adds the extras.**
   The box then disappears. You never need to do this again.

Pasted the wrong key, or got a new one? Ask the owner.

Part 2: Publishing your mod

For everyone who makes mods for the pack. No git and no commands to learn — the launcher's **CREATOR** button uploads only your own mod, so nobody can overwrite anybody else's work.

1

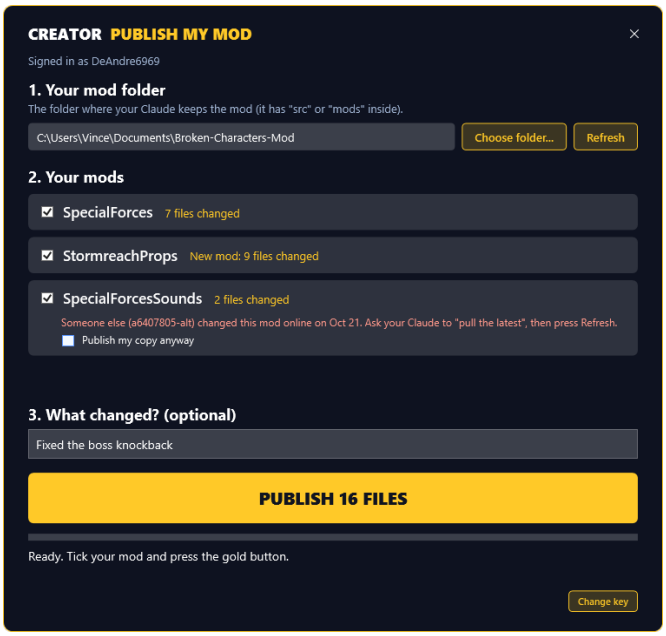
Open the launcher and click CREATOR.
The first time, it asks for your creator key. Paste it and press Save Key — you only do this once (see **Getting your creator key** below).

2

Choose your mod folder.
It's the folder where your Claude keeps the mod (it has a **src** or **mods** folder inside). The launcher remembers it next time.

3

Tick your mod and press the big gold PUBLISH button.
It uploads, the pack builds on GitHub, and it tells you if it worked. Everyone gets it next time they open the launcher.



The Creator window.

Safe by design: it only uploads your own mod and never deletes anything.

Warns you first: if someone else changed one of your files online, it tells you before replacing it.

If the build fails: press "Copy errors for Claude" and paste them to your Claude. It will fix it.

Updates take about 5 to 10 minutes to build. You can close the window and keep playing.

Getting your creator key

Your key is a long piece of text from your own GitHub account — like a password for this one job. Keep it private and never post it in chat or the repo. Each creator generates their own; **never share one key between people.**

1

Open this page while signed in to GitHub:
github.com/settings/tokens/new?scopes=public_repo&description=Broken%20Characters

2 **Scroll down and click Generate token.**

3 **Copy the text it shows.**
It only shows it once.

4 **In the launcher, click CREATOR, paste it, and press Save Key.**

Just playing? You don’t need any of this — close the Creator window and press PLAY.

Broken Characters Mod — a friends-only Risk of Rain 2 pack.